16.4 Respiratory Distress Syndrome*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Grunting, nasal flaring and chest recession • RR 70/min • SpO_2 85%	**ACTUAL** Impaired gas exchange related to surfactant deficiency as evidenced by grunting, retractions and hypoxemia.	• SpO_2 within the target range for gestation.	• Give CPAP or oxygen as prescribed. • Assist with surfactant administration. • Follow SpO_2, RR and blood gases. • Handle the baby as little as possible.	• Met at target SpO_2.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Working hard to breathe • Grunting	**ACTUAL** Ineffective breathing pattern related to pulmonary immaturity as evidenced by tachypnea and retractions.	• Less work of breathing within 24–48 hours.	• Position to keep the airway open. • Suction only when needed. • Group care to save oxygen.	• Achieved as breathing improves.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Cannot feed by mouth • On IV fluids	**RISK** Risk for physical injury as evidenced by risk factors: hypoglycemia associated with physiological stress and inability to feed.	• Blood glucose stays normal.	• Give IV dextrose as prescribed. • Check glucose per protocol. • Start enteral feeds when ordered.	• Outcome reached while glucose is normal.

* **References for this care plan:** [35], [38], [142]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.